

What Counts as Evidence? Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 35-45 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	35-45 min
Difficulty	Extended	ID	what-counts-as-evidence

Big idea: AOKs use different standards of evidence.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students compare standards of evidence across AOKs.

Student Prompt

Inspect What Counts as Evidence? Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

What Counts as Evidence? Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Claims from mathematics, art, history, science, and ethics sorted by evidence type. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
What Counts as Evidence? Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A card set with proof, testimony, data, interpretation, and expert judgement. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
What Counts as Evidence? Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A comparison of what each AOK accepts and rejects as evidence. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — AOKs use different standards of evidence.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting What Counts as Evidence? Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from What Counts as Evidence? Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Does evidence mean the same thing in every AOK?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Cross-AOK.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how aoks use different standards of evidence.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Does evidence mean the same thing in every AOK?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: Claims from mathematics, art, history, science, and ethics sorted by evidence type.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Claims from mathematics, art, history, science, and ethics sorted by evidence type.
- A card set with proof, testimony, data, interpretation, and expert judgement.
- A comparison of what each AOK accepts and rejects as evidence.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/what-counts-as-evidence/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/what-counts-as-evidence/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/what-counts-as-evidence/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Assign each group an AOK: mathematics, natural sciences, human sciences, history or arts.
2. Each group decides what evidence would support the claim in that AOK.
3. Groups present their evidence standard.
4. The class discusses whether the same claim means the same thing in every AOK.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Does evidence mean the same thing in every AOK?

- Are some AOKs more reliable, or just differently reliable?
- Can different AOKs answer the same question validly but differently?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...